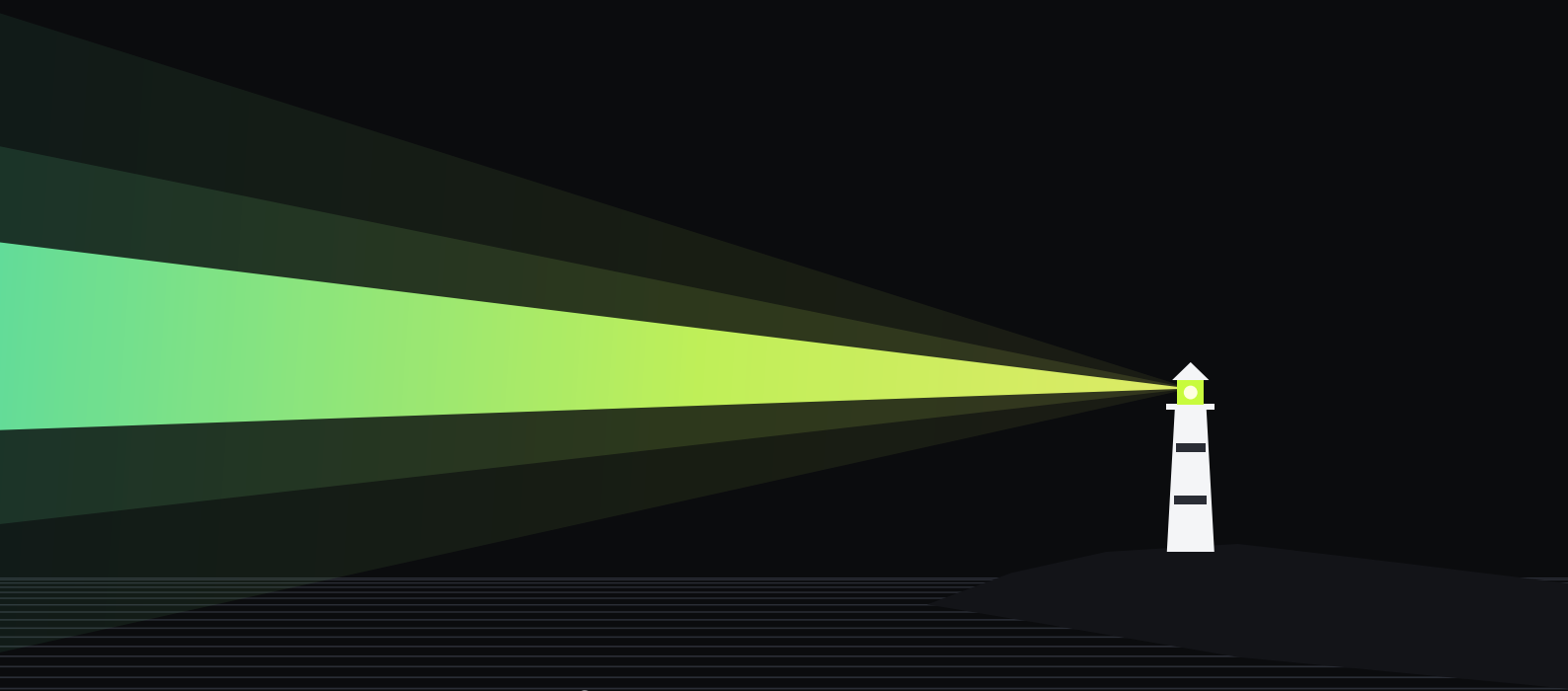
A quarterly for things at the edge

Margin

NO. 07 · LIGHT · AUTUMN 2026



3 **The last keeper of Cape Ardıç**
Thirty-one years, 112 steps, one lamp

4 **Roll three**
Inside the lamp room: twelve frames by Jonah Pell

5 **Write for us**
The contributor agreement

TRY Every line on this cover opens its page.

EDITOR’S LETTER

Keeping a light on

This issue began with a letter. Nevin Sarıgül wrote to us in the spring to say that her lighthouse was going automatic, and that she would like someone to write it down before it was forgotten. We went in June, and again in September, and both times we stayed until the lamp came on.

Every piece in No. 07 is about a light that somebody keeps: a lamp, a darkroom, a kitchen window at four in the morning. None of them is about the light itself. They are about the people who stay awake for it.

Read slowly. Write in the margins. That is what they are for.

Mira Castell, editor

MARGIN NOTES

In this issue

1 **Cover**
A lighthouse, a beam, three ways in

2 **Editor’s letter**
Why this issue keeps a light on

3 **The last keeper of Cape Ardıç**
Thirty-one years, 112 steps, one lamp

4 **Roll three**
Twelve frames from the lamp room

5 **Write for us**
The contributor agreement

From the editor’s folder

Three more pages, a scanned letter, the printer’s invoice and the flatplan, are in the sample on a computer or tablet.

TRY Select a sentence and tap Highlight. Then tap Edit and write in the margin with the Pen.

FEATURE · LIGHT

The last keeper of Cape Ardıç

For thirty-one years, Nevin Sarıgül climbed 112 steps every evening to light the lamp at the end of the cape. In March the light went automatic. She still climbs.

Words **Defne Aras** · Photographs **Jonah Pell**

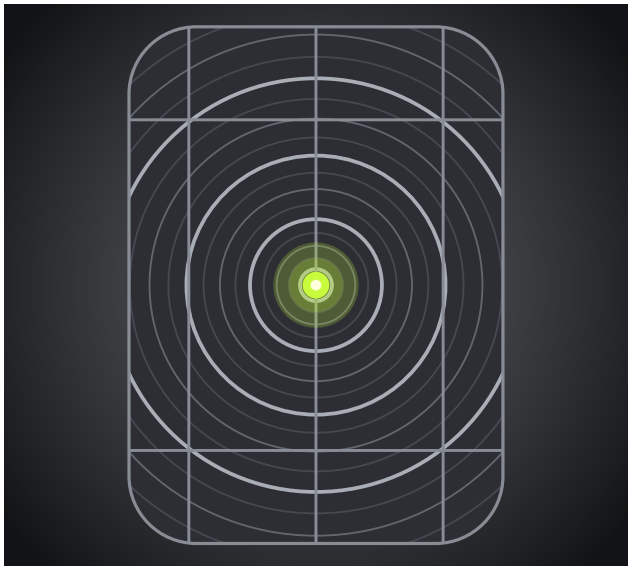
Up in the lamp room it smells of metal polish and paraffin, though none has burned here since 1987. Nevin Sarıgül opens the window a hand's width, as she has every evening since she came in 1995 with one suitcase and a cat called Pusula. Below us the sea is the colour of slate, and the first fishing boats are already leaving the harbour.

Her job was easy to describe and hard to do: light the lamp at sunset, wind the clockwork that turns the lens, keep the glass clean, and write everything in the logbook, the wind, the visibility, each passing ship. She did it alone for thirty-one years, through the storms that twice took the roof off the oil store.

In March a small grey box came from the coastal authority. It holds a sensor, a battery and a radio, and it turns the light on by itself when the evening grows dark enough. Nobody has to climb the stairs to the lamp any more.

Nobody, that is, except Nevin. She still goes up at dusk, checks the box has done its work, and writes one line in the logbook. Most nights it is the same line: Light on, all well.

> FROM THE LOGBOOK
>
> 12 September. Wind SW 3, visibility good. Two boats out, two boats home. Light on at 19:21, all well.



The first-order lens, made in 1906, still turns once every ten seconds. Photograph: Jonah Pell

The lens is as big as a little room, a beehive of glass prisms that gathers one weak flame and throws it twenty-two nautical miles out to sea. Every Sunday she cleans it with a soft cloth and a bowl of warm water, one prism at a time.

> "A lighthouse is only a promise that someone is still awake."

When I ask whether she minds the box, she laughs. The machine is better at keeping time, she says, but it never notices the weather turning, or a boat that is late home. On those nights she stays up anyway, with the kettle and the radio, till the last boat is in.*

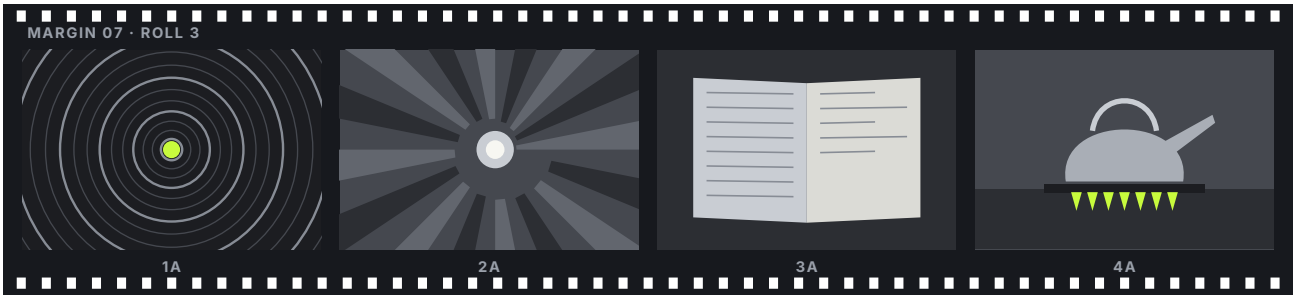
* Cape Ardıç and everyone in this article are fictional, like every name in this sample.

TRY Tap Edit, choose Edit text, then tap any paragraph. Put your name in the byline, or add a sentence and watch the column reflow.

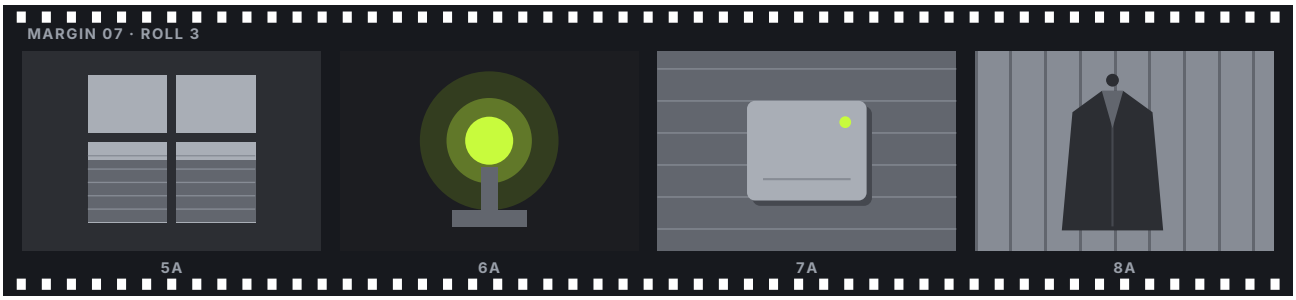
PHOTOGRAPHS · ROLL 3

Inside the lamp room

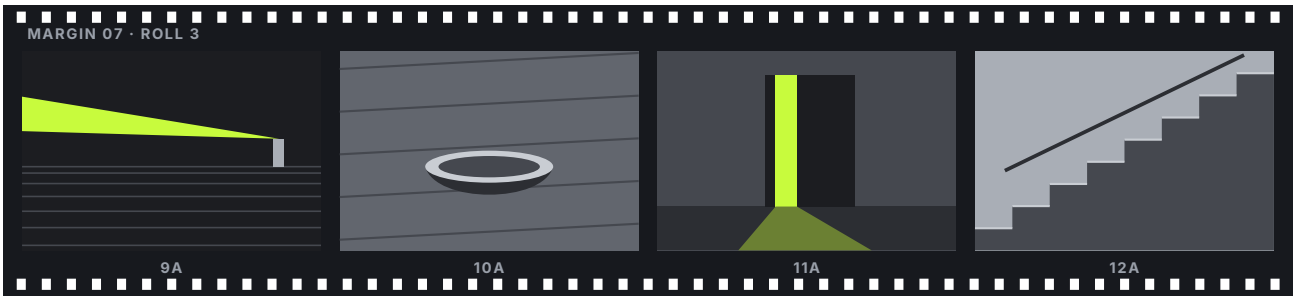
Twelve frames from the September visit, printed as they came off the roll. One of them runs on page 3.



3/01 3/02 3/03 3/04



3/05 3/06 3/07 3/08



3/09 3/10 3/11 3/12

Pick one for page 3. — J.P.

TRY Tap Edit and circle the frame you would print with the Pen. Text adds a few words beside it.

MARGIN NO. 07 · LIGHT

Contributor agreement

Thank you for writing for Margin. This agreement covers your piece in No. 07. We may print it once in this issue and keep it in our online archive.

Everything else stays yours. You may publish the piece anywhere from 1 January 2027. We pay within 30 days of publication.

Your details

YOUR NAME

DATE

EMAIL

YOUR FEE

- ◯ Pay my fee of €240 by bank transfer
- ◯ Give my fee to the Cape Ardıç Lighthouse Trust

☐ I have read this agreement and accept it.

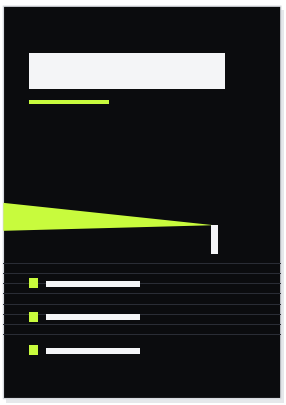
SIGNATURE

× _____

TRY Tap a field and type; › on the bar moves to the next. Then tap Edit, choose Sign, and sign on the line.

FLATPLAN · NO. 07

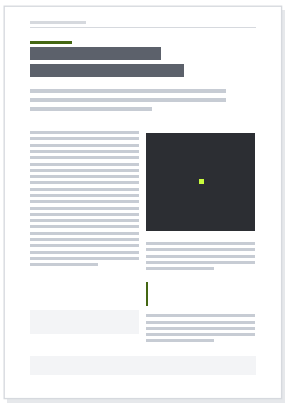
Every page at once



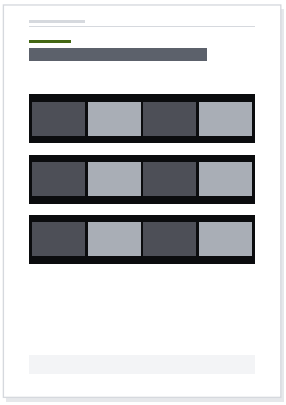
1 Cover



2 Letter



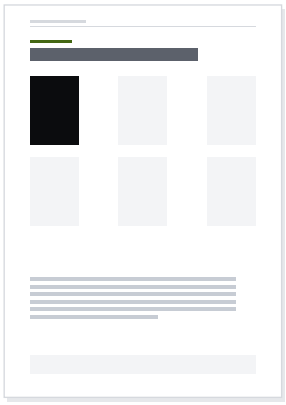
3 Feature



4 Contact sheet



5 Agreement



6 Flatplan

Mira: the contact sheet should follow the agreement. Swap 4 and 5?

Pinch any page smaller to see them all. Tap a page to go back into it.

Press and hold a page, then drag it to move it. Select lets you rotate, delete or share pages; Add brings in pages from another file.

Your changes stay on this device. When you are done, choose Save a copy or Share a copy in the More menu.

The scanned letter, the invoice and every other tool are in the sample on a computer or tablet.

That is the whole issue. Open your own PDFs whenever you are ready.

TRY Pinch this page smaller, then press and hold page 4 and drag it after page 5.